

The Watch

*For thirty-five years
This Sailor has stood the watch
While some of us were in our bunks at night
This Sailor stood the watch
While some of us were in school
learning our trade
This shipmate stood the watch
Yes... even before some of us were
born into this world
This shipmate stood the watch
In those years when the storm clouds of war
were seen brewing on the horizon of history
This shipmate stood the watch
Many times she would cast an eye ashore
and see her family standing there
Needing her guidance and help
Needing that hand to hold
during those hard times
But she still stood the watch
She stood the watch for thirty-five years
She stood the watch so that we,
our families and our fellow countrymen could
sleep soundly in safety, each and every night
Knowing that a Sailor stood the watch
Today we are here to say
"Shipmate... the watch stands relieved
Relieved by those you have trained,
guided, and led
Shipmate you stand relieved..
we have the watch..."*



Retirement Ceremony

IN HONOR OF



CDR ALEXA STRIBA

UNITED STATES NAVY



Sequence of Events

RETIREMENT CEREMONY IN HONOR OF COMMANDER ALEXA STRIBA

Friday, 17 July 2026 | 1000
CNATTU Oceana, Hangar 1
Naval Air Station Oceana, Virginia Beach, Virginia



Guest Speaker
Master of Ceremonies
Invocation
Photographer
Side Boys

CDR Eric Alexander
AOCS (Ret) Marvin Knowles
Pastor Tommy Smith
CNATTU PAO

National Anthem
Color Guard
"Old Glory"
Passing of the Flag

AOCM (Ret) Nikki Williams
AOCM (Ret) Chance Eidson
AOCS (Ret) Monica Lyde
AOC (Ret) Gloria Johnson
AOC Samanatha Taich
AOC Raffy Padrigio
AO2 Beatrice Anima
CNATTU Color Guard
ATC Bobby Fenwick
ENS Saudia Sutton

"The Mothers Watch"
"The Watch"

AOC Samanatha Taich
AOC Ivianna Ortiz
AO1 Tyesha Simon
AO1 Petergay Brooks
AO1 Estefania Paczmayorga
AO1 Joi Townsel
AO2 Beatrice Anima

"The Children's Watch"
Honor Boatswain
Bell Ringer
Ushers

YN3 Kelvin Torres
CWO4 Allen Harris
AO1 Malik Baldwin
Mrs. Amanda Baylor
ABHC David Brownlee
ADC Dominic Valdez
LS1 Ashley Kelly

Ceremony Coordinators

ATI Adrian Frausto
YN3 Kelvin Torres
LTJG Dionne Scott
Priscilla Gamble

A Personal Reflection...

Thirty-five years ago, a young woman raised between two cultures took a leap of faith and joined the United States Navy. I could never have imagined the extraordinary journey that would follow.

The Navy gave me more than a career it gave me purpose, lifelong friendships, unforgettable experiences, and the privilege of serving alongside some of the finest men and women our nation has to offer. From my first day as an Airman Recruit to the honor of retiring as a Commander, every challenge, deployment, duty station, and milestone helped shape the person I am today.

Along the way, I learned that leadership is not about rank it is about people. It is about serving others, building trust, lifting those around you, and leaving every organization better than you found it.

To my mother, Betsy, thank you for your unconditional love, strength, and faith in me. The values you instilled in me became the foundation upon which I built my life and career.

To my daughter, Destinii, thank you for being my greatest blessing and my greatest motivation. Every promotion, achievement, and milestone carried greater meaning because I knew I was building a legacy for you. Of all the titles I have held throughout my life, none has meant more to me than being your mother.

To my son, Rashid, though you are no longer with us, you have never left my heart. Through every challenge and every success, I have carried your memory with me. While I wish you were here to celebrate this day, I find comfort knowing your spirit remains a part of every step of this journey.

To my grandson, Kairo, you are one of God's greatest gifts. Your smile, laughter, and innocence remind me daily of what truly matters. As one chapter closes, I look forward to spending more time watching you grow and creating memories that will last a lifetime.

To my siblings, Adriana, Andres, and Ana, thank you for your love and support. Your encouragement has meant everything to me.

To the rest of my family, friends, and those who have become like family your encouragement and presence have meant more than words can express.

I am also grateful to the countless mentors, leaders, Sailors, Marines, civilians, and friends who became family throughout my 35 years of service. You helped shape me into the leader and person I am today.

Above all, I thank God. Through every challenge, triumph, deployment, and homecoming, His grace has guided my path and blessed me beyond measure.

As I turn the page to a new chapter, I do so with immense gratitude. While my time in uniform comes to an end, my commitment to service does not. It has been the honor of a lifetime to serve this great nation alongside each of you.

Thank you for being part of my journey.



Commander Douglas A Kesterson *Presiding Officer*

Cmdr. Doug Kesterson, a native of San Antonio,, Texas enlisted in the U.S. Navy in 1999 as an aviation ordnance technician and reported for duty to the VFA-83 "RAMPAGERS." During his tour, he completed two combat deployments to the Persian Gulf onboard the USS GEORGE WASHINGTON (CVN-73) and earned his Enlisted Aviation Warfare Specialist Designation.

In 2004, he attended Basic Instructor Training school at FTC Norfolk, Virginia and then checked in to the Strike Fighter Weapon School, Atlantic (SFWSLANT) as a Weapons Loading Instructor. During his time there he assisted seven squadrons in the successful transition from the F-14 "TOMCAT" to the F/A-18E/F "SUPER HORNET," and performed a number of Conventional Weapon Loading Proficiency Inspections (CWTPPI) on Atlantic Fleet Squadrons.

In May of 2007, Cmdr. Kesterson was assigned to the VFA-131 "WILDCATS." He deployed with the USS GEORGE WASHINGTON (CVN-73) on a Partners of America cruise and made two deployments to the Fifth Fleet area of responsibility onboard the USS DWIGHT D. EISENHOWER (CVN-69) serving as the Ordnance LPO, the Line Division LPO, and a Quality Assurance Representative. In 2010, he was initiated as a Chief Petty Officer and served as a Maintenance Control Safe for Flight Representative, Phased Maintenance Coordinator, and Ordnance Leading Chief Petty Officer.

In October 2011, Cmdr. Kesterson was commissioned to the rank of Ensign and attended LDO/CWO indoctrination at Officer Training Command (OTC) Newport, Rhode Island.

In November 2011, he traveled to Bremerton, Washington and was assigned to the USS JOHN C. STENNIS (CVN-74) as the G-4 Division Officer and Weapons Elevator Officer. He also served as the G-5 Division Officer and Weapons Quality Assurance Officer and successfully completed two deployments to the Persian Gulf.

In August 2014, he traveled to Kaneohe Bay, Hawaii where he was assigned as the Marine Aircraft Group 24 Ordnance Department Head. During his tour, he orchestrated explosive operations for Marine Rotational Force-Darwin, MAG-24 squadrons, and provided I-level munitions and Aircraft Armament Systems maintenance for CPRW-2 squadrons. In 2015, he was honored by the Honolulu Navy League and awarded the Navy League Award for Excellence.

In October 2017, Cmdr. Kesterson reported to Carrier Air Wing TWO (CVW-2) as the Carrier Air Wing Weapons Officer. He completed an operational deployment to the Western Pacific, RIMPAC 2018, SUSTEX 2018, and Fleet Battle Problem 29. Additionally, he was the lead weapons integrator with Program Office/TYPE-WING/NAVAIR reps to capture requirements enabling the standup of the Navy's AIR WING OF THE FUTURE; the first CVW to incorporate F-35C. He shaped CVN-deck density solutions, and was the lead voice in 5th generation weapons capabilities/gaps.

In August 2020, Cmdr. Kesterson reported to Commander, Strike Fighter Wing Pacific (CSFWP) as the Weapons Department Head where he was responsible for the training and readiness of F/A-18 aircraft assigned to CSFWP. Additionally, he managed \$579 million in Aircraft Armament Equipment and supported weapon systems in acquisition planning, assessing risk, and contract tracking.

In November 2021, Cmdr. Kesterson reported to the USS DWIGHT D. EISENHOWER (CVN-69) as the Ordnance Handling Officer where he led over 295 officers and Sailors through all aspects of ammunition stowage, handling, and assembly of conventional weapons and the maintenance and upkeep of assigned magazine sprinkler systems and elevators.

In April 2023, Cmdr. Kesterson was reassigned to the Bureau of Naval Personnel in Millington, Tennessee as a Personnel Assignments Officer.

Cmdr. Kesterson's professional qualifications include a Master's Degree in Organizational Leadership from Brandman University, a Bachelor's Degree in General Studies from Columbia College, a certified Master Training Specialist, and earned Lean Six Sigma Champion and Black Belt certifications through the Management and Strategy Institute.

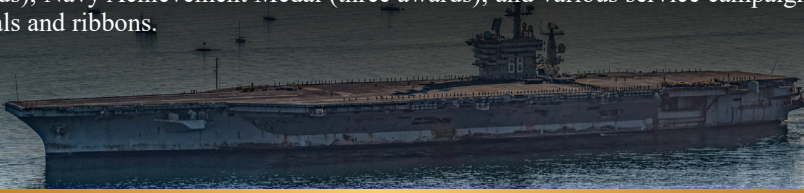
His personal awards include the Navy and Marine Corps Commendation Medal (6), the Navy and Marine Corps Achievement Medal (7), Navy Good Conduct Medal (3), and various service and campaign awards.



Commander Eric Alexander *Guest Speaker*

Hailing from Stuttgart, Arkansas, “The Rice & Duck Capital of the World”, Commander Alexander entered the U.S. Navy on January 4, 1995. After basic training in Great Lakes, IL, he attended Aviation Boatswain’s Mate (ABF) “A” School in Millington, TN, where he received entry level training on Aviation Fuel Systems. He graduated from ABF “A” School on the morning of April 19, 1995, which was also the morning of the Oklahoma City Bombing. He was subsequently assigned to USS WASP (LHD-1), in Norfolk, VA; Naval Air Technical Training

Center (NATTC), Pensacola, FL; and USS THEODORE ROOSEVELT (CVN-71), in Norfolk, VA. Shortly after being promoted to Chief Petty Officer in 2005 onboard the THEODORE ROOSEVELT, he was selected for the Limited Duty Officer Commissioning Program. After being commissioned in February 2007, he received orders to USS JOHN C. STENNIS (CVN-74), in Bremerton, WA, as the Crash and Salvage Officer, where he participated in Operation Enduring Freedom, for the second time. In August 2010 he transferred to Sasebo, Japan, onboard the USS ESSEX (LHD-2), where he served again as the Crash and Salvage Officer. Additionally, while onboard, he served as coordinator for the geographic hull swap of USS ESSEX (LHD-2) and USS BONHOMME RICHARD (LHD-6), in May 2012. After transferring from the USS BONHOMME RICHARD in July 2013, he reported onboard USS GEORGE WASHINGTON (CVN-73) in Yokosuka, Japan, as the Flight Deck Officer. After a successful CVN hull swap with USS RONALD REAGAN (CVN-76) in August 2015, he would continue serving as Flight Deck Officer. In January 2017, Commander Alexander reported to COMNAVAIRPAC in San Diego, CA, where he served as the Force Fuels Program Officer. He would then return to Bremerton, WA, and report onboard the USS NIMITZ (CVN-68) as the “Handler”, in February 2018. After a successful tour onboard NIMITZ, to include an 11-month deployment during the height of the COVID-19 pandemic, he transferred to Navy Personnel Command (NPC) in Millington, TN, as the Assistant Aviation LDO/CWO Assignments Detailer, in April 2021. Next, he would return to NATTC Pensacola and would then serve as the “Air Boss” of the Air Training Department. Commander Alexander was selected for Commander Command in 2024 and reported to Navy Talent Acquisition Group (NTAG) New Orleans in March 2025, where he currently serves as the Executive Officer. He has a Bachelor of Science degree in Interdisciplinary Studies from Embry Riddle Aeronautical University, and a Master of Science degree in Management and Leadership Effectiveness from Troy University. His personal awards include the Meritorious Service Medal (two awards); Navy Commendation Medal (six awards); Navy Achievement Medal (three awards); and various service campaign medals and ribbons.



Commander Alexa Striba *Retiree*

Commander Alexa Striba, a native of Manhattan, New York, enlisted in the U.S. Navy in 1991 and completed recruit training in Orlando, FL. She attended Aviation Ordnance “A” School at Naval Aviation Technical Training Center in Memphis, Tennessee. Her first assignment was with the Weapons Department at Naval Support Facility Diego Garcia, followed by a deployment with VP-10 to Puerto Rico supporting counter-drug operations in 1993.

In 1995, she joined VP-8, participating in Operations Sharp Guard and Decisive Endeavor from Naval Air Station Sigonella, Italy. She later transferred to Naval Air Technical Training Center Pensacola, Florida, where she earned her Master Training Specialist designation. In 2001, she reported to USS Theodore Roosevelt (CVN-71), deploying three times in support of Operations Southern Watch, Enduring Freedom, and Iraqi Freedom. In 2005, she was selected for Limited Duty Officer.

Commander Striba’s officer assignments include serving as Ordnance Officer-in-Charge at Pohang, Republic of Korea, and Air Gunner aboard USS Theodore Roosevelt during a deployment supporting Operation Enduring Freedom. In 2009, she joined Strike Fighter Wing Atlantic as the Air Launch Weapons Team Gunner, where she was responsible for ordnance logistics for 17 Strike Fighter Squadrons.

In 2012, she returned to USS Theodore Roosevelt as Weapons Assembly Division Officer, leading 126 Sailors through critical milestones and the 2015 deployment. In 2017, she was selected as a leadership instructor at the Center for Personal and Professional Development, Dam Neck. She was later hand-picked to serve as the Weapons Division Head and command representative on the Weapons Systems Explosive Review Board at the Naval Safety Center in Norfolk, Virginia.

Promoted to Lieutenant Commander in 2017, she served as the Ordnance Handling Officer aboard USS Harry S. Truman (CVN-75) during the 2018-2019 deployments in support of maritime security operations. She was then appointed Force Ordnance Handling Officer for Commander, Naval Air Forces Atlantic, overseeing ordnance personnel across seven aircraft carriers and six type wings. She became the first female Force Ordnance Handling Officer and the third woman to reach the rank of Commander as an Aviation Ordnance Limited Duty Officer.

In 2022, Commander Striba volunteered as Department Head aboard USS George H.W. Bush (CVN-77), leading 280 Sailors through critical milestones and the 2022-23 deployment. Lastly, She served as the first female Commanding Officer at the Center for Naval Aviation Technical Training Unit Oceana.

Commander Striba’s personal awards include the Meritorious Service Medal, Navy and Marine Corps Commendation Medal, and Navy and Marine Corps Achievement Medal. She holds a Bachelor of Arts in Organizational Leadership from Ashford University and a Master of Executive Leadership from Liberty University.